

From Faculty Profile to Accreditation Capacity: A Faculty-Development and Quality-Assurance Framework for Non- Accredited IT Programs

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ABSTRACT

This article synthesizes Lagon's faculty competence, commitment, readiness, AACCUP Area II framework, and recommendations into an institutional development model for non-accredited IT programs in state universities and colleges. The source study found very high competence and commitment and high readiness overall, while identifying significant group differences in competence by academic rank and in commitment by age and academic rank. It recommended maintaining competence and commitment, strengthening campuses with minimal or inadequate accreditation requirements, pursuing Level I accreditation where ready, and providing full-time scholarships and financial assistance to faculty, especially younger and part-time instructors, to support graduate study and academic-rank progression. The proposed framework organizes these source-derived recommendations into five capacity domains: qualification, competence, commitment, accreditation evidence, and career support. It is presented as a practice framework rather than as a tested intervention.

Keywords: *faculty development, accreditation capacity, scholarships, academic rank, AACCUP, IT programs, SUCs*

INTRODUCTION

The dissertation was designed not only to describe faculty characteristics but also to inform accreditation preparation. Its significance section identifies program planners, administrators, deans, IT directors, faculty, AACCUP, students, parents, communities, and future researchers as potential users of the findings. The final recommendations focus on sustaining competence and commitment and improving faculty profiles through scholarships and career development.

This manuscript converts those recommendations into an implementation-oriented framework for academic units preparing non-accredited IT programs for quality assurance. The framework is derived from the source and is not presented as an intervention whose effectiveness has already been tested.

Source Findings That Inform Capacity Building

Source finding Management implication

Competence was Very High overall Preserve and update technology skills rather than assume basic deficiency.

Competence differed significantly by academic rank Career progression and advanced development deserve attention.

Commitment was Very High overall Protect institutional practices that sustain engagement and loyalty.

Commitment differed by age and academic rank Younger and part-time faculty may need stronger mentoring and career pathways.

Readiness was Highly Ready overall Move from preparation toward formal accreditation where evidence is complete.

Readiness was not significantly different by demographics or location Focus on program systems and evidence, not demographic composition.

Readiness did not correlate significantly with competence or commitment Manage accreditation documentation and processes as a distinct capacity domain.

Five Capacity Domains

Domain Source basis Practical actions

Qualifications and staffing AACUP Area II: qualifications, recruitment, adequacy, loading, rank and tenure

Map faculty qualifications, specialization, licenses, appointments, loads, and promotion records.

2. Technology competence Very high competence; rank difference Maintain current technical skills; provide advanced, role-specific training; support instructional technology integration.

3. Organizational commitment Very high commitment; age and rank differences Use mentoring, recognition, participation, and clear career pathways to sustain engagement.

Accreditation evidence systems Readiness checklist and null correlations with competence/commitment

Build evidence files, policies, faculty profiles, development records, evaluation outputs, and exhibits.

Graduate study and career support Source recommendation for full-time scholarships and financial assistance

Prioritize younger and part-time instructors for graduate study, scholarship, and progression opportunities.

Scholarships as a Faculty-Profile Strategy

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The source explicitly recommends that SUCs grant full-time scholarships and extend financial assistance so faculty can pursue graduate study. It further links this support to helping younger and part-time instructors become permanent or advance in academic rank. This recommendation connects three elements of the dissertation: educational qualifications, academic-rank differences, and accreditation expectations for faculty profiles.

For implementation, scholarships should be tied to a documented faculty-development plan rather than treated as isolated benefits. Programs can identify qualification gaps, forecast courses and specialization needs, select scholars based on program priorities, and monitor return-service and professional outputs.

Readiness-to-Accreditation Pathway

Stage Key action Evidence of completion

Diagnose Use Area II checklist to locate missing faculty requirements Gap matrix by sub-area

Develop Address qualification, training, loading, rank, and policy gaps Faculty-development and staffing plan

Document Organize policies, profiles, reports, evaluation records, and exhibits Accreditation evidence repository

Internal review Conduct self-survey against the accreditation instrument Internal readiness report and corrective actions

5. Apply and sustain Proceed to formal accreditation when requirements are sufficiently complete Application, survey results, and continuing improvement plan

Governance Implications

The source places responsibility across administrators, program planners, deans, directors, and faculty. A readiness strategy should therefore assign owners to each Area II requirement. Faculty development cannot be separated from budget, human-resource policies, workload systems, promotion, and records management. The dissertation's recommendation to maintain competence and commitment while improving inadequate campus requirements also supports continuous quality improvement. Accreditation should be treated as an institutional process that organizes evidence of quality, not as a one-time documentation campaign.

Limitations of the Framework

This framework is a synthesis of a study conducted during School Year 2011-2012 and published as a book edition in 2021. Accreditation standards and institutional

conditions may have changed. Before operational use, current AACUP and regulatory requirements should be checked separately. The present framework is faithful to the uploaded source and does not claim current regulatory validity.

CONCLUSION

Lagon's findings support a faculty-development strategy that preserves strong competence and commitment while strengthening the institutional systems required for accreditation. The most actionable source recommendation is to link graduate-study support and academic career progression with faculty-profile improvement. A five-domain capacity model - qualifications, competence, commitment, accreditation evidence, and career support - provides a practical way to translate the dissertation into a quality-assurance agenda without overstating what the original cross-sectional study proves.

REFERENCE

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